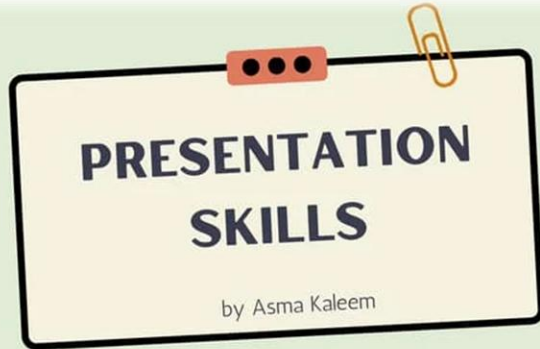


LECTURE 8

Writing Persuasive & Negative Message



EMBA 501
Business Communication
Ayesha Siddika Arshi
Lecturer
Dept. of Finance & Banking

Learning Objectives:

1. Discuss five steps for delivering a successful presentation.
2. Explain the growing importance of the backchannel in presentations and list six steps for giving effective presentations online.
3. Creating and delivering presentations.

Planning a Presentation

- Presentations offer important opportunities to put all your **communication skills on display**, including research, planning, writing, visual design, and interpersonal and nonverbal communication.
- If the thought of giving a **speech or presentation makes you nervous**, keep three points in mind.
 - i. First, everybody gets nervous when speaking in front of groups.
 - ii. Second, being nervous is actually a good thing; it means you care about the topic, your audience, and your career success.
 - iii. Third, with practice, you can convert those nervous feelings into positive energy that helps you give more compelling presentations.

Step 1: Analyzing The Situation

- As with written communications, analyzing the situation for a presentation involves **defining your purpose and developing an audience profile**.
- The purpose of most of your presentations will be to **inform or to persuade**, although you may occasionally need to make a collaborative presentation, such as when you're leading a problem-solving or brainstorming session.
- Given the **time limitations** of most presentations and the **live nature** of the event, make sure your purpose is crystal clear so that you make the most of the opportunity and show respect for your listeners' time and attention.
- You also need to determine whether your audience is comfortable listening to the language you speak.

Step 2: Assessing the Environment

- For in-person presentations, pay close attention to **seating arrangements**.
- **The four basic formats have distinct advantages and disadvantages:**
 - Classroom or theater seating, in which all chairs or desks face forward, helps keep attention focused on the speaker and is usually the best method for accommodating large audiences. However, this arrangement inhibits interaction among audience members, so it is not desirable for brainstorming or other collaborative activities.
 - Conference table seating, in which people sit along both sides of a long table and the speaker stands at one end, is a common arrangement for smaller meetings. It promotes interaction among attendees, but it tends to isolate the speaker at one end of the room.

Step 2: Assessing the Environment

- The four basic formats have distinct advantages and disadvantages:
- Horseshoe, or U-shaped, seating, in which tables are arranged in the shape of a U, improves on conference table seating by allowing the speaker to walk between the tables to interact with individual audience members.
- Café seating, in which people sit in groups at individual tables, is best for breakout sessions and other small-group activities. However, this arrangement is less than ideal for anything more than short presentations because it places some in the audience with their backs to the speaker, making it awkward for both them and the presenter.
- If you can't control the seating arrangement, at least be aware of what it is so you can adjust your plans if necessary.

Step 3: Selecting The Best Combination Of Media And Channels

- For some presentations, you'll be expected to use whatever media and channels your audience, your boss, or the circumstances require. For example, you might be required to use specific presentation software and a conference room's built-in display system or your company's online meeting software.
- For other presentations, though, you might have an array of choices, from live, in person presentations to webcasts (online presentations that people either view live or download later from the web), screencasts (recordings of activity on computer displays with audio voiceover).

Step 4: Organizing A Presentation

- The possibilities for organizing a business presentation fall into two basic categories: linear or nonlinear.
- 1. **Linear presentations** are like **printed documents** in the sense that they are outlined like conventional messages and follow a predefined flow from start to finish. The linear model is **appropriate for speeches, technical and financial presentations**, and other presentations in which you want to convey your message point by point or build up to a conclusion following logical steps.
- 2. In contrast, a **nonlinear presentation** doesn't flow in any particular direction but rather **gives the presenter the option to move back and forth between topics** and up and down in terms of level of detail. Nonlinear presentations can be useful when you want to be able to **show complicated relationships between multiple ideas or elements**, to zoom in and out between the “big picture” and specific details, to explore complex visuals, or to have the flexibility to move from topic to topic in any order.

Crafting Presentation Content

- Although you usually don't write out a presentation word for word, you still engage in the writing process—developing your ideas, structuring support points, phrasing your transitions, and so on.
- Your audience's size, the venue (in person or online), your subject, your purpose, your budget, the time available for preparation, and the time allotted for your talk all influence the style of your presentation.
- Like written documents, presentations comprise distinct elements: **the introduction, the body, and the close.**

Presentation Introduction

- A good introduction arouses the audience's interest in your topic, establishes your credibility, and prepares the audience for what will follow.

A. Arousing Audience Interest: Some subjects are naturally more interesting to some audiences than others. Here are **six ways to arouse audience interest:**

1. **Unite the audience around a common goal.**
2. **Tell a story.**
3. **Pass around product samples or other objects.**
4. **Ask a question.**
5. **Share a startling statistic.**
6. **Use humor.**

Presentation Introduction

B. Building Your Credibility: In addition to grabbing the audience's attention, your introduction needs to establish your credibility.

C. Previewing Your Message: In addition to arousing audience interest and establishing your credibility, a good introduction gives your audience members a preview of what's ahead, helping them understand the structure and content of your message.

Presentation Body

- The bulk of your speech or presentation is devoted to a discussion of the main supporting points from your outline. Whether you're using the direct or indirect approach, make sure the organization of your presentation is clear, and your presentation holds the audience's attention.
- A. **Connecting Your Ideas:** Help your listeners move from one key point to the next with generous use of transitions.
- B. **Holding Your Audience's Attention:** After you've successfully captured your audience's attention in your introduction, you need to work to keep it throughout the body of your presentation.

Presentation Closing

- The close of a speech or presentation has two critical jobs to accomplish: making sure your listeners leave with the key points from your talk clear in their minds and putting your audience in the appropriate emotional state.
- A. **Restating Your Main Points:** Use the close to succinctly restate your main points, emphasizing what you want your listeners to do or to think.
- **First**, increase the overall level of compensation
 - **Second**, establish a cash bonus program
 - **Third**, offer a variety of stock-based incentives
 - **Fourth**, improve our health insurance and pension benefits.
- B. **Ending with Clarity and Confidence:** If you've been successful with the introduction and body of your presentation, your listeners have the information they need and are in the right frame of mind to put that information to good use.

Delivering a Presentation

- With an outline, speaking notes, and any visual aids you plan to use, you're almost ready to deliver your presentation.

A. Choosing Your Presentation Method:

1. **Memorizing.** Except for extremely short speeches, trying to memorize an entire presentation is not a good idea. In the best of circumstances, you'll probably sound stilted; in the worst, you might forget your lines.
2. **Reading.** In a few rare instances you may need to read a speech from a prepared script. For instance, policy statements and legal documents are sometimes read in full because the wording can be critical.
3. **Speaking from an outline or notes.** Speaking with the help of an outline or note cards is nearly always the easiest and most effective delivery mode.
4. **Impromptu speaking.** From time to time, you may be called upon unexpectedly to give an impromptu or extemporaneous speech on the spot, without the benefit of any planning or practice.

Delivering a Presentation

- With an outline, speaking notes, and any visual aids you plan to use, you're almost ready to deliver your presentation.

B. Practicing Your Delivery:

- **Can you present your material naturally, without reading your slides?**
- **Is the equipment working, and do you know how to use it?**
- **Could you still make a compelling and complete presentation if you experience an equipment failure and have to proceed without using your slides at all?**
- **Is your timing on track?**
- **Can you easily pronounce all the words you plan to use?**
- **Have you anticipated likely questions and objections?**

C. Preparing To Speak:

In addition to knowing your material thoroughly and practicing your delivery, make sure your location is ready, you have everything you'll need, and you're prepared to address audiences from other cultures, if that applies.

Delivering a Presentation

- With an outline, speaking notes, and any visual aids you plan to use, you're almost ready to deliver your presentation.

D. Overcoming Anxiety:

Recognize that nervousness is an indication that you care about your audience, your topic, and the occasion.

- Put yourself into a positive frame of mind before you start.
- Stop worrying about being perfect.
- Know your subject.
- Practice, practice, practice.
- Visualize success.
- Remember to breathe.
- Be ready with your opening line.
- Be comfortable.
- Take a three second break.
- Concentrate on your message and your audience not on yourself.
- Maintain eye contact with friendly audience, members.
- Keep going.

Delivering a Presentation

- With an outline, speaking notes, and any visual aids you plan to use, you're almost ready to deliver your presentation.

E. Handling Questions Responsively:

Whether you take questions during a formal question-and-answer (Q&A) period or as they come up during your presentation, audience queries are often one of the most important parts of a presentation.

F. Embracing The Backchannel:

- Integrate social media into the presentation process.
- Monitor and ask for feedback.
- Review comments to improve your presentation.
- Automatically tweet key points from your presentation while you speak.
- Establish expectations with the audience.

Delivering a Presentation

Giving Presentations Online

Online presentations offer many benefits, including the opportunity to **communicate with a geographically dispersed audience at a fraction of the cost** of travel and the ability for a project team or an entire organization to meet at a moment's notice.

- Consider sending preview study materials ahead of time.
- Rehearse using the system live, if at all possible.
- Keep your presentation as simple as possible.
- Ask for feedback frequently.
- Consider the viewing experience from the audience members' point of view.
- Allow plenty of time for everyone to get connected and familiar with the screen they're viewing.

Using Structured Slides

- They follow the same basic format throughout the presentation.
- Based directly on the templates built in PowerPoint.
- Feature bullet points.

☐ Advantages of Structured Slides:

1. Easy to create by choosing an overall design scheme for the presentation.
2. Less time taking.
3. A more practical choice.
4. More information can be packed onto each slide.
5. More effective in conveying complex ideas or sets of interrelated data.

☐ Disadvantages of Structured Slides:

1. Creates a mind-numbing effect of text-heavy slides that all look alike.
2. Less audience attention.

Using Free-Form Slides

- These are highly visual, uniquely designed presentation slides that reject uniform, template-based structures (like standard bullet-point lists).
- Instead, they focus on visual orientation, using images, shapes, and minimal text to tell a compelling story, which makes them ideal for motivational and persuasive speeches.
- They don't follow a rigid structure.
- Complementary approach of visuals and words is a highlight of free-form design.

Using Free-Form Slides

❑ Advantages of Structured Slides:

1. Such slides provide both visual and textual information.
2. They prevent cognitive overload by limiting the amount of information delivered at any one time.
3. Helping viewers process information by identifying priorities and connections. For instance, by highlighting important data points on a graph.
4. Appropriate imagery and thoughtful design create a more dynamic and engaging experience for audience.
5. Such slides are good for motivational, educational and persuasive purposes. Particularly when they will be used multiple times they will compensate for the extra time employed to create them.

Using Free-Form Slides

❑ Disadvantages of Structured Slides:

1. Designing slides with visuals and textual elements is more creatively demanding and time consuming.
2. With less textual information on slides, the speaker is responsible for conveying more of the content.
3. If not handled carefully, division of content into smaller chunks can make it difficult to present complex subjects in a cohesive and integrated manner.

Designing Effective Slides

How can you design an effective slide?

- Presentation software is just a tool and can be used both properly and poorly.
- A presentation should not be dull and slide heavy as it will make it difficult for audience to understand. **“Death by Power Point”**
- A reason for ineffective slides is treating them as stand-alone documents, that can be read without a presenter. Such “slideuments” are ineffective.
- Create an effective slide set and a separate handout for detail and supporting information.
- Another alternative is to use **notes field** in your presentation software for speaking notes for each slide.
- But if a slideument is your only option, then be clear and simple. Do not overload slides. As having a large number of simpler slides is better than a small number of complex slides.

Designing Effective Slides

Design Elements:

1. Colour
2. Artwork
3. Typeface/ Type Style

Designing Effective Slides

Design Elements: Colour

- Colour is very crucial, it is far more than decoration.
- It grabs attention, emphasize importance and establishes contrast.
- It increases overall acceptance of your message by 60%.
- It increases willingness to read by 80%.
- Enhance learning and improves retention by 75 %.

Selecting Colours for Background and Text:

- When presenting in a dark room use dark background with light colour text.
- When presenting in a well-lit room use light background with dark colour text.

Red text is bad on black	Yellow text is good on black
Cyan text is bad on orange	Black text is good on orange
Magenta text is bad on green	Black text is good on green
Green text is bad on blue	White text is good on blue
Grey text is bad on grey	White text is good on grey

Designing Effective Slides

Design Elements: **Artwork**

- The less a background does, the better.
- It should not be flashy and cluttered.
- It should stay at the background and must not compete with the foreground.
- Use solid colours.
- In the background all artwork is decorative.
- In the foreground artwork can either be functional or decorative.



Designing Effective Slides

Design Elements: **Typeface/ Type Style**

- Avoid decorative typefaces or use them carefully. For Example, *TYPEFACE TYPE STYLE*.
- Limit the number of typefaces to one or two per slide.
- When using thinner typefaces, use boldface so that they don't disappear when displayed on screen.
- Avoid most italicized type, it is difficult to read when projected.
- Avoid all-capitalized words and phrases.
- Allow extra white space between lines.

Using too **MANY**
typefaces is
confusing *and* **LOOKS**
messy and **CLUTTERED**.

THE END.

